

Pain Diary Template

The core record. Built to capture pain, meds, sleep, function, and pattern without sending you through a maze.

Routing Note

- Need:** This is the main tool. Not content for content's sake. A working record for when pain is already eating your focus.
- Tool:** Pick this when you need one sheet that can hold symptoms, meds, function, sleep, and pattern evidence without sending you through a maze.
- Rule:** The record does not need to be beautiful. It needs to be true, dated, and usable under pressure.

Patient Information

Name: _____

Date Range: _____

Condition(s): _____

Current Medications: _____

Pain Scale Reference (0–10 NRS)



Pain Quality Descriptors

Use these terms when describing your pain type: Aching • Burning • Stabbing • Throbbing • Shooting • Tingling • Cramping • Pressing • Sharp • Dull • Radiating • Pulsing • Electric • Stinging • Gnawing

Daily Pain Log — Week of: _____

Fill in one row per day. Rate pain on the 0–10 NRS. Use the quality descriptors above. Mark the primary location (e.g. lower back, R knee, neck).

Day	Date	AM Pain	PM Pain	Eve Pain	Worst	Location(s)	Quality
Mon							
Tue							
Wed							
Thu							
Fri							
Sat							
Sun							

Medications & Treatments

Record everything you take or do for pain: prescriptions, OTC meds, topicals, heat/ice, physio exercises, etc. Rate relief 0–10.

Day	Medication / Treatment	Dose / Duration	Time Taken	Relief (0-10)	Side Effects?
Mon					
Tue					
Wed					
Thu					
Fri					
Sat					
Sun					

Triggers & Activities

Check any triggers or factors present each day. Add your own in the blank columns. This helps identify patterns over time.

Day	Weather	Stress	Poor Sleep	Physical Activity	Sitting/Posture	Food/Drink	_____
Mon							
Tue							
Wed							
Thu							
Fri							
Sat							
Sun							

Sleep & Energy

Rate sleep quality 1–5 (1 = terrible, 5 = excellent). Rate morning energy 0–10. Note anything that disturbed sleep.

Day	Bedtime	Wake Time	Hours Slept	Sleep Quality (1-5)	Morning Energy (0-10)	Disturbances
Mon						
Tue						
Wed						
Thu						
Fri						
Sat						
Sun						

Mood & Functional Impact

Rate mood and each functional area: 0 = unable, 5 = managed with difficulty, 10 = normal. This documents how pain affects daily life.

Day	Mood (0-10)	Self-Care	Housework	Walking	Work / School	Social / Family
Mon						
Tue						
Wed						
Thu						
Fri						
Sat						
Sun						

Notes for Your Healthcare Provider

Use this space to record patterns you noticed, questions for your doctor, concerns about your treatment, or anything else you want to discuss at your next appointment.

Observations, Patterns, and Questions

Weekly Summary

Complete this at the end of each week. Summarizing helps you and your provider spot trends faster.

Average pain this week (0–10): _____

Highest / Lowest pain this week: _____

Number of "bad" days (pain 6+): _____

Most common trigger: _____

Most effective relief: _____

Functional impact (what couldn't you do?): _____

Changes to discuss with provider: _____

Goals for next week: _____

Tracking Rules That Hold Under Pressure

- Consistency beats polish. Fill it at the same time each day and let the record accumulate weight.
- On brutal days, write less, not nothing. A pain number and two hard facts still count as proof.
- Two honest weeks usually reveal more than one dramatic page written after the fact.
- Clinicians scan fast. Hand them dates, patterns, limits, and treatment response they can trust immediately.

- Compare best days to worst days. That gap is where trigger logic usually shows itself.
- Rate in the moment when you can. Memory edits pain into something cleaner or louder than it was.
- Keep the sheet where collapse happens: bedside, meds drawer, bag, kitchen table.
- For claims and reviews, dated repetition carries more force than retrospective summary.

Need the same record with less friction? PainTracker — paintracker.ca

Same evidence, sharper routing. Local-first reports, encrypted offline storage, trend review without blog-maze nonsense.
Runs on your device. Your record stays with you unless you decide otherwise.